

Government approves fund for startups

The government of India wants to reverse the trend of successful startups relocating abroad to receive venture funding. Thus, it has approved a US\$ 1.5 billion 'Fund of Funds for Startups.' With this move, the government hopes to generate employment for 1.8 million people.

The official release stated, "The

Cabinet has approved the establishment of a 'Fund of Funds for Startups' at Small Industries Development Bank of India for contribution to various alternative investment funds registered with SEBI, which would extend funding support to startups." The fund will cover support at the seed, early and growth stages.

Government gives nod to Kochi electronics cluster

The government of India has given its final consent to set up a greenfield electronics manufacturing cluster under Make in India initiative at Kakkanad in Ernakulam, Kerala. The project proposes to create an industrial park of international standards with all modern facilities.

Kerala, with its vast talent pool of

electronics engineering graduates, presents an attractive proposition to the electronics manufacturing industry. The project will be executed in a phased manner. The units that will come up will be eligible for the privileges under MSIPS. The central government will provide ₹ 500 million as a grant.

India, UK to work together in solar, nano-material research

India and the UK have agreed to work together in the fields of solar energy and nano-material research.

As a part of the commitment to Solar Alliance, a centre on solar energy will be established. It will be linked to

India's renewable energy mission and the UK's Supergens Programme. India will invest ₹ 500 million over a period of five years with a matching contribution from the Research Council UK under the Newton-Bhabha Programme.

India's e-waste growing at 30 per cent per annum

According to a recent study by ASSOCHAM-cKinetics, India is one of the world's major electronic waste generators. It is likely to generate 5.2 million metric tonnes per annum by 2020 from the current level of 1.8 metric tonnes, suggesting an alarming CAGR of about 30 per cent.

Global volume of e-waste gener-

ated is expected to reach 130 million tonnes in 2018, up from 93.5 million tonnes in 2016, with a CAGR of 17.6 per cent from 2016 to 2018.

In India, computer equipment accounts for almost 70 per cent of e-waste, followed by telecommunication equipment (12 per cent), electrical equipment (eight per cent)

and medical equipment (seven per cent).

Unfortunately, a mere 1.5 per cent of India's total e-waste gets recycled due to poor infrastructure and a weak legislation framework. Over 95 per cent of e-waste generated is managed by the unorganised sector and scrap dealers.

On The Move

HCL Tech promotes Vijay Kumar as COO

IT services company, HCL Technologies has promoted president - infrastructure services, C. Vijay Kumar, to take on additional responsibility as chief operating officer. A role of chief operating officer has been established to accelerate growth in the core business. Kumar will continue to report to Anant Gupta, president and chief executive officer.

Sanjay Kalirona quits Intex Tech

Sanjay Kalirona has resigned from the post of Intex Technologies' mobile business head. He will be moving on after 15 years at the IT peripherals-to-mobile phones company.

Samson David leaves Infosys

Infosys veteran Samson David, who was recently tasked to spearhead the company's flagship artificial intelligence platform Mana, has resigned from the company. Other than Mana, David was also heading the company's Cloud, infrastructure and security unit, which currently generates over US\$ 1 billion in annual revenue.